The Next Care Steps Checklist

What to gather, sort and ask before anything else gets decided about your husband's care.

The discharge is set, the rehab wants an answer, the pharmacy has questions, and the list keeps getting longer. Before anyone decides what comes first, make sure you have these in hand. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is simply something still to do this week.

Gather

- [ ] The assessment findings you've been given so far, and the questions nobody has answered yet, together in one folder or one notebook.
- [ ] Everything that's on your mind about his care, on one list, in any order: your daughter's list, the sticky notes, the things you remember in the car.
- [ ] Each date you've been given, with the name of the person who gave it.
- [ ] The names and phone numbers of the people to call with questions. [1]

Sort

- [ ] Beside each item on the list, a letter: D for a decision (a choice the family has to make), T for a task (something someone does), Q for a question (something to find out).
- [ ] Beside each date, “given” if someone actually told you, or “assumed” if the family has been working to it without being told.
- [ ] A circle around the decision with the nearest date that someone gave you.
- [ ] Under that decision, the things that have to be settled before it can be made.
- [ ] A mark beside the tasks that are for later, or that are waiting on something else.

Ask

- [ ] The person who gave you each date: is it firm?
- [ ] For each open question, who can answer it: his doctor or nurse, the pharmacist, the social worker or your care consultant. And who in the family will make that call.
- [ ] Each person who has offered to help: which tasks they're willing to take. Write a name beside a task only when that person has said yes.
- [ ] Yourself: which of these you can realistically keep doing, and which you'd hand over if someone offered.
- [ ] Your husband: who he wants to see this list once it's sorted.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you gather, sort and ask. It doesn't put your husband's care decisions in order, and it doesn't say who should do what. Those rest on his whole situation and on the people who assess him, and they're what the next step below is for.

Ready for the next step?

You've pulled the list together, sorted it, and you know whom to ask. The care interview takes it from there: it walks you through your husband's situation area by area, so what comes first rests on the whole picture and not only on this week's list, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The item marked 1 follows Medicare's discharge planning checklist; the rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Your Discharge Planning Checklist (CMS Product No. 11376)